Nimbus Field Guide

A short guide to the Nimbus command-line tool

Observations

Installing on Windows

The Windows installer places Nimbus in your user folder, so it needs no administrator rights. After installing, open a new terminal so that the nimbus command is on your path.

If the installer stops at 80 percent, an antivirus scan is usually holding the files. Wait two minutes before cancelling, since the scan normally finishes on its own.

Observations

Installing on Linux

On Linux, Nimbus ships as a single binary. Copy it to a folder on your path and make it executable; there are no other dependencies to install.

The binary checks for a newer version once a week. Set NIMBUS_NO_UPDATE_CHECK to any value to turn the check off on machines without internet access.

Observations

Signing in

Run nimbus login and follow the link it prints. The sign-in token is stored in your keychain and stays valid for 30 days of inactivity.

On a shared machine, run nimbus logout when you finish. It removes the token from the keychain but leaves your synced files in place.

Observations

How syncing works

Nimbus compares each file with the server by its checksum, not its modification time. A file that only changed locally is uploaded; one that only changed on the server is downloaded.

When a file changed on both sides, Nimbus keeps both copies and adds the device name to the newer one. Nothing is overwritten without a copy.

Observations

Excluding files

List patterns in a file named .nimbusignore at the top of the workspace, one per line. Build folders and editor swap files are good candidates.

Excluded files are never uploaded, but files that were synced before being excluded stay on the server until you delete them there.